

WRONG

1. Passage anchor

> “I was always afraid of saying **the wrong thing**...”

Passage meaning

wrong = not correct, appropriate, suitable, or acceptable in the situation

錯的；**不恰當的**；**不合適的**

Here, **the wrong thing** means something socially or contextually inappropriate—not necessarily factually false.

Practice

1. I was worried that I might say **the wrong thing** in front of everyone.

我擔心自己會在大家面前**說錯話**。

2. He chose **the wrong words** and accidentally offended her.

他用了**不恰當的措辭**，無意中冒犯了她。

Core meanings of WRONG

2. wrong — not correct or true

= incorrect; not factually accurate

錯的；**不正確的**

Examples

1. Your answer is **wrong**.

你的答案是**錯的**。

2. I think we took the **wrong road**.

我想我們走了**錯的路**。

This is the most basic meaning.

3. be wrong about something

= have an incorrect belief, judgment, or understanding

****對.....判斷錯誤；弄錯****

Examples

1. I was ****wrong about him****.

我****看錯他了****。

2. She was ****wrong about the date****.

她把日期****弄錯了****。

4. get something wrong

= understand, remember, calculate, or identify something incorrectly

****弄錯；答錯；理解錯****

Examples

1. I ****got the address wrong****.

我把地址****弄錯了****。

2. Don't worry if you ****get a few questions wrong****.

就算有幾題****答錯****也不用擔心。

Very common learner pattern.

5. go wrong

= develop incorrectly; fail; stop functioning as intended

****出錯；出問題；出故障****

Examples

1. Something ****went wrong**** during the experiment.

實驗過程中****出了問題****。

2. The machine suddenly ****went wrong****.

那台機器突然****故障了****。

Depending on context:

* 計畫出錯

* 系統故障

* 情況變糟

Incorrect choice, direction, or person

6. the wrong + noun

= not the correct one among possible choices

錯的；選錯的

Examples

1. I sent the email to **the wrong person**.

我把電子郵件寄給了**錯的人**。

2. We got on **the wrong bus**.

我們搭上了**錯的公車**。

Common:

* wrong number

* wrong address

* wrong door

* wrong person

* wrong train

* wrong answer

7. wrong way

A. incorrect direction

走錯方向

1. You're going **the wrong way**.

你走**錯方向了**。

B. incorrect method

方法不對

2. You're approaching the problem **the wrong way**.

你處理這個問題的**方法不對**。

8. wrong side

= incorrect side, position, or orientation

錯的一邊；反面

Examples

1. You're wearing your shirt **the wrong way round**.

你的衣服**穿反了**。

2. We parked on **the wrong side of the road**.

我們把車停在了**錯的一側**。

Social appropriateness

9. wrong — inappropriate or unsuitable

= not suitable for a situation

不合適的；不恰當的

This is central to the passage use.

Examples

1. That was **the wrong time** to bring up the issue.

那不是提出這個問題的**適當時機**。

2. He wore **the wrong clothes** for the occasion.

他那個場合穿了**不合適的衣服**。

10. say the wrong thing

= say something inappropriate, awkward, offensive, or badly judged

說錯話；說了不恰當的話

Examples

1. I'm always afraid of **saying the wrong thing** at formal events.

我在正式場合總怕自己會**說錯話**。

2. She realized immediately that she had **said the wrong thing**.

她立刻意識到自己**說錯話了**。

Passage nuance

This does not necessarily mean the sentence was grammatically or factually incorrect. It may mean socially awkward or inappropriate.

11. wrong person / wrong place / wrong time — situational mismatch

= unsuitable or inappropriate in the circumstances

人不對；場合不對；時機不對

Examples

1. He was the **wrong person for the job**.

他不是這份工作的**合適人選**。

2. We were simply in the **wrong place at the wrong time**.

我們只是碰巧在**不對的時間出現在不對的地方**。

Morality and ethics

12. wrong — morally bad or unacceptable

= morally incorrect, unjust, or unethical

錯誤的；不道德的；不應該的

Examples

1. It is **wrong to cheat**.

作弊是不對的。

2. She knew that what she had done was **wrong**.

她知道自己做的事是**錯的 / 不對的**。

This is distinct from factual incorrectness.

13. right and wrong

= morally correct and morally incorrect behavior

是非；對錯；善惡

Examples

1. Children gradually learn the difference between **right and wrong**.

孩子會逐漸學會分辨**是非對錯**。

2. The film raises questions about **right and wrong**.

這部電影提出了關於**善惡是非**的問題。

14. do wrong

= act immorally or unfairly

做錯事；作惡；做不對的事

Examples

1. He knew he had **done wrong**.

他知道自己**做錯了事**。

2. People who **do wrong** should still be treated fairly.

做錯事的人仍應受到公平對待。

Somewhat formal or literary.

15. wrong someone

= treat someone unfairly or unjustly

虧待；冤枉；不公正地對待

Examples

1. She felt that the company had **wronged her**.

她覺得公司**虧待了她**。

2. He wanted to apologize to those he had **wronged**.

他想向那些自己曾經**傷害或虧待過的人**道歉。

This is the verb **wrong**, a distinct but useful sense.

16. a wrong

= an unjust or immoral act

****錯事；不義行為；冤屈****

Examples

1. Two ****wrongs**** don't make a right.

****以錯制錯並不能變成對的。****

2. The law was intended to correct past ****wrongs****.

這項法律旨在糾正過去的****不公正行為****。

This noun sense is more formal.

Fault, malfunction, and condition

17. something is wrong with something

= there is a problem, fault, or abnormality

****.....有問題；.....不對勁****

Examples

1. There's something ****wrong with the computer****.

這台電腦****有問題****。

2. I think something is ****wrong with the engine****.

我想引擎****出了問題****。

Very common.

18. something is wrong with someone

= someone is unwell, upset, or behaving unusually

****某人不舒服 / 不對勁 / 有狀況****

Examples

1. Is something ****wrong with you****?

你是不是****哪裡不舒服 / 有什麼事****？

2. I could tell that something was ****wrong with her****.

我看得出來她****有些不對勁****。

Context determines whether this concerns:

- * health
- * mood
- * behavior
- * situation

19. what's wrong?

= what is the problem?

****怎麼了？出了什麼事？****

Examples

1. You look upset. ****What's wrong?****

你看起來很難過。****怎麼了？****

2. ****What's wrong with the printer?****

印表機****出了什麼問題？****

Highly common everyday use.

Mistaken belief or judgment

20. prove someone wrong

= show that someone's belief, prediction, or claim is incorrect

****證明某人錯了****

Examples

1. Everyone doubted her, but she ****proved them wrong****.

大家都懷疑她，但她最後****證明他們錯了****。

2. I hope the results ****prove me wrong****.

我希望結果能****證明我的判斷是錯的****。

21. admit you were wrong

= acknowledge that your opinion, belief, or action was incorrect

****承認自己錯了****

Examples

1. He eventually ****admitted he was wrong****.

他最後****承認自己錯了****。

2. It takes courage to ****admit you're wrong****.

****承認自己犯錯****需要勇氣。

22. don't get me wrong

= do not misunderstand what I mean

****別誤會我的意思****

Examples

1. ****Don't get me wrong****—I like the idea, but it needs work.

****別誤會我的意思****，我喜歡這個構想，只是它還需要改進。

2. ****Don't get me wrong****, I'm not criticizing you personally.

****別誤會****，我不是在針對你個人。

Highly useful discourse expression.

23. get someone wrong

= misunderstand someone's meaning, personality, or intention

****誤解某人；看錯某人****

Examples

1. I think you've ****got me wrong****.

我想你****誤解我了****。

2. At first, I ****got him completely wrong****.

一開始，我完全****看錯他了****。

Wrongly / incorrect attribution

24. wrongly

= incorrectly or unjustly

****錯誤地；不當地；冤枉地****

Examples

1. She was ****wrongly accused**** of stealing.
她被****錯誤地 / 冤枉地指控****偷竊。
2. The report ****wrongly stated**** that the event had been cancelled.
報告****錯誤地聲稱****活動已被取消。

The meaning can be:

* factually incorrectly

* unjustly

25. wrongfully

= illegally or unjustly, especially in formal/legal contexts

****非法地；不公正地；冤枉地****

Examples

1. He was ****wrongfully imprisoned****.
他被****冤枉入獄****。
2. The employee claimed she had been ****wrongfully dismissed****.
那名員工聲稱自己遭到****不當解僱****。

Distinction

****wrongly**** is general.

****wrongfully**** is more formal and often legal.

Fixed expressions

26. get off on the wrong foot

= begin a relationship or activity badly

一開始就不順；開局不佳

Examples

1. We **got off on the wrong foot**, but later became good friends.
我們一開始**相處不太順**，但後來成了好朋友。
2. I don't want to **get off on the wrong foot** with my new boss.
我不想和新主管**一開始就留下壞印象**。

27. rub someone the wrong way

= annoy or irritate someone because of your manner

惹某人不高興；讓某人反感

Examples

1. His attitude **rubbed me the wrong way**.
他的態度讓我**很反感**。
2. She sometimes **rubs people the wrong way** without realizing it.
她有時會在不自覺間**惹人不快**。

Idiomatic and informal.

28. on the wrong side of someone

= have made someone angry or hostile toward you

得罪某人；惹某人不高興

Examples

1. You don't want to get **on the wrong side of the manager**.
你最好不要**得罪經理**。
2. He somehow got **on the wrong side of his colleagues**.
他不知怎麼地**得罪了同事**。

29. the wrong end of the stick

= a misunderstanding of a situation

****誤會；搞錯情況****

Examples

1. I think you've got ****the wrong end of the stick****.
我想你****誤會了****。
2. She completely got ****the wrong end of the stick**** about my comment.
她完全****誤解了我那句話的意思****。

Especially common in British English.

30. two wrongs don't make a right

= one bad act does not justify another bad act

****別人的錯不能合理化你的錯；以錯制錯仍是錯****

Examples

1. He insulted you first, but ****two wrongs don't make a right****.
他先侮辱你沒錯，但****以錯制錯也不對****。
2. Remember, ****two wrongs don't make a right****.
記住，****兩個錯並不會變成一個對****。

Related noun and adjective family

31. wrongdoing

= illegal, immoral, or dishonest behavior

****不法行為；不當行為；做壞事****

Examples

1. The investigation found evidence of ****wrongdoing****.
調查發現了****不當行為****的證據。
2. He denied any ****wrongdoing****.

他否認有任何**不法行為**。

Formal and especially common in legal/business/news contexts.

32. wrongdoer

= a person who does something illegal or immoral

做壞事的人；違法者；作惡者

Examples

1. The law is intended to punish **wrongdoers**.
這項法律旨在懲罰**違法者**。
2. Victims deserve protection from **wrongdoers**.
受害者應受到保護，免受**作惡者**傷害。

33. wrongful

= unjust, illegal, or improper

不正當的；非法的；冤枉的

Examples

1. He filed a **wrongful dismissal** claim.
他提出**不當解僱**申訴。
2. The family received compensation for **wrongful imprisonment**.
那個家庭因**冤獄**獲得賠償。

Common legal collocations:

- * wrongful dismissal
- * wrongful death
- * wrongful conviction
- * wrongful imprisonment

Key contrasts

34. wrong vs incorrect

wrong is broader and more everyday.

It can mean:

- * factually incorrect
- * unsuitable
- * morally bad
- * malfunctioning

incorrect mainly means factually or technically not correct.

Compare:

- * a **wrong answer** / an **incorrect answer**
- * the **wrong person** ✓
- * an **incorrect person** ✗ in most ordinary contexts
- * morally **wrong** ✓
- * morally **incorrect** sounds unnatural

35. wrong vs false

wrong

= incorrect judgment, answer, choice, etc.

false

= untrue; not genuine; deliberately or objectively contrary to fact

Compare:

- * a **wrong answer**
- * a **false statement**
- * a **false name**
- * false information

A statement can be **false**, while a person who believes it may simply be **wrong**.

36. wrong vs bad

wrong

= incorrect, inappropriate, or morally unacceptable

****bad****

= poor in quality, unpleasant, harmful, or morally bad

Compare:

* the ****wrong answer**** = 答案不正確

* a ****bad answer**** = 答得不好

These are not the same.

37. wrong vs inappropriate

****wrong**** can be broad and conversational.

****inappropriate**** specifically emphasizes unsuitability for a context, situation, audience, or standard.

In the passage:

****say the wrong thing****

often means:

****say something inappropriate****

rather than:

****say something factually incorrect****

Meaning map

The core concept of ****wrong**** is:

****not matching what is correct, proper, intended, or expected****

From that develop several branches:

****fact****

→ wrong answer

→ ****錯誤的****

****choice****

→ wrong bus / wrong person

→ ****選錯的****

****context****

→ wrong thing to say

→ ****不恰當的****

****morality****

→ morally wrong

→ ****不道德的 / 不對的****

****function****

→ something is wrong with the machine

→ ****出問題****

****understanding****

→ get someone wrong

→ ****誤解****

****justice****

→ wrong someone / wrongful conviction

→ ****虧待 / 不公正的****

Passage recap

> “I was always afraid of saying ****the wrong thing****...”

Here, ****wrong**** means:

****inappropriate, badly judged, or socially unsuitable in the situation****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****說錯話****

* ****說了不恰當的話****

* ****說了不合時宜的話****

MCQ-ready meaning

****wrong**** in ****“say the wrong thing”****

= ****not appropriate or suitable for the situation****

****不恰當的 ; 不合適的****

It does not have to mean factually false.